



FIRST VIOLIN

Mozart's first violin was a workmanlike instrument made in Salzburg in the 1740s by Andreas Ferdinand Mayr, luthier to the archbishop's court and a musician colleague of Leopold Mozart.

Tours and triumphs

Returning to Salzburg in 1763, Leopold was promoted to deputy master of the chapel at the prince-archbishop's court and immediately took another, longer leave of absence. The family traveled to Paris, where the children performed in front of the French king Louis XV, and then on to London, where they stayed for over a year in 1764–1765, giving many public concerts. They were befriended by composer Johann Christian Bach, a son of Johann Sebastian Bach who was a prominent figure on London's music scene. J.C. Bach's lucid but dramatic and emotional compositional style was to be a major influence on Mozart's